ALCHEMY ARCHITECT

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The "My plan" column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students' hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction to Alchemy. Guided exploration of the interface.	Slides 1–6: the hook, what a synthesizer is, the seven classes, steps 1 and 2, and start simple. Hand out the project sheet and the Explore sheet; students explore with headphones.	Slides 1–6	p. 12, p. 17, p. 18, p. 19, p. 21
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Sound design basics — oscillators, filters, envelopes. Begin designing Patch 1.	Slides 7–11: oscillators, the filter, the envelope, modulation, then a live demo building Patch 1. Students begin their first Patch card.	Slides 7–11	p. 10, p. 13
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Design remaining patches and compose your track.	Slide 12: Patches 2 and 3. Aim for variety. Then work time.	Slide 12	p. 14
CLASS 4		Slide 13: design first, compose second; fill in the Track plan. Then work time.	Slide 13	p. 15
CLASS 5		Full working day: finish the track, layer and thicken. Ask each student to play you one patch alone and say its job in the track.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 14–16: effects, mix and bounce, what you turn in, the rubric. Students self-score, bounce and post their three questions.	Slides 14–16	p. 16, p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 17–18: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate's questions.	Slides 17–18	p. 22

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

From my common struggles: start with the Simple view before opening Advanced. Let students play and listen on Class 1; the Explore sheet (page 12) keeps them moving without turning it into a lecture.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Slides 12 and 13 open Classes 3 and 4; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate and ask: what is this patch for, and have you saved it?

PREVIEW

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ALCHEMY ARCHITECT

Worked example · three invented patches

EXAMPLE

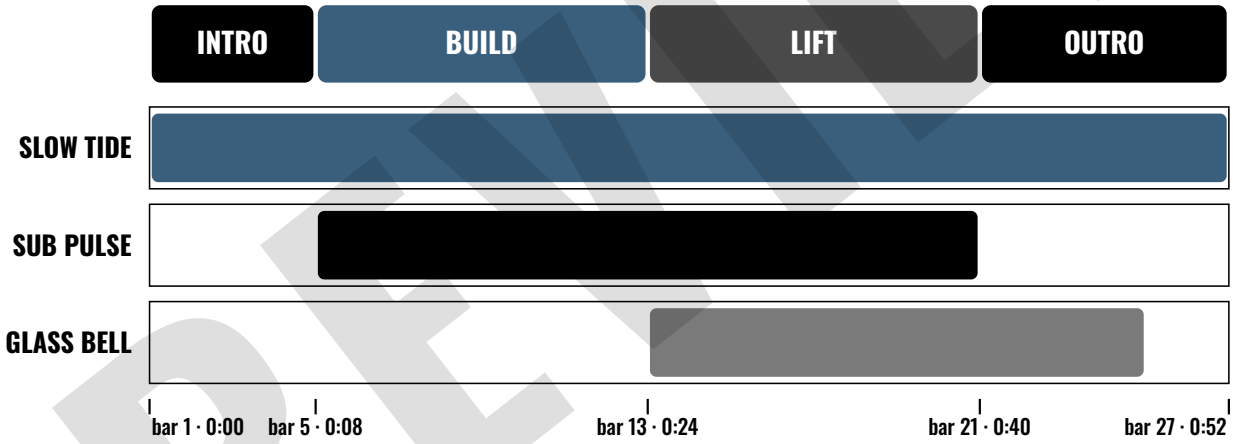
Teacher

Three **invented patches and a 26-bar plan, described on paper**: no audio is included, so the numbers are easy to check. Students' sounds will differ.

1 · THREE PATCHES, THREE JOBS ·

PATCH	SOURCE	FILTER	ENVELOPE	MOTION	EFFECTS
Slow Tide Pad	Two saw waves, the second tuned slightly sharp	Low-pass, cutoff 1000 Hz, a little resonance	A 1 s · D 0.5 s · S 80% · R 1.5 s	LFO 0.5 Hz on the cutoff	Reverb, chorus
Sub Pulse Bass	One square wave at 55 Hz (A1)	Low-pass, cutoff 400 Hz	A 0.005 s · D 0.2 s · S 70% · R 0.1 s	None: steady	None, kept clean
Glass Bell Melody	Two sine waves, the second one octave up	Open: a sine has nothing above its pitch to cut	A 0.01 s · D 1.2 s · S 0% · R 1.5 s	None: the long decay is the movement	Reverb, quarter-note delay

2 · THE TRACK PLAN: 26 BARS AT 120 BPM ·



Intro bars 1–4, Build bars 5–12, Lift bars 13–20, Outro bars 21–26. One bar is 2 s, so 26 bars is 52 s: inside my 45–60 second requirement.

3 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

Slow Tide plays a note at 110 Hz. With the cutoff at 1000 Hz, 1000 ÷ 110 = 9.09, so harmonics 1 to 9 pass. Its LFO at 0.5 Hz takes 2 s, which is one bar. Sub Pulse at 55 Hz with a 400 Hz cutoff keeps the odd harmonics 1, 3, 5 and 7 (55, 165, 275, 385 Hz). Glass Bell's second sine is 440 Hz when the first is 220 Hz. A quarter-note delay at 120 BPM is 500 ms.

4 · THE SHAPE OF THE TRACK

The pad opens alone and carries the piece. The bass joins at bar 5 (0:08) to start the Build. The bell enters at bar 13 (0:24) for the Lift, the bass drops out at bar 21 (0:40), and the pad and bell fade in the Outro.

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ALCHEMY ARCHITECT

STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Design at least 3 original patches in Alchemy
- ☐ Use oscillators, filters, and modulation in your sound design
- ☐ Compose a 45–60 second track featuring all of your custom sounds
- ☐ Apply effects and automation for expressivity
- ☐ Mix and bounce your track for presentation

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Explore** — Open Alchemy and experiment with the interface, sound sources, and presets (Explore sheet: page 12)
2. **Learn the building blocks** — Understand oscillators, filters, envelopes, and modulation routing (Synth guide: page 10)
3. **Design Patch 1** — Create your first original sound from scratch. Save it. (Patch card: page 13)
4. **Design Patches 2 & 3** — Build two more distinct sounds. Aim for variety. (Patch cards: page 14)
5. **Compose** — Use your 3 patches to build a 45–60 second track (Track plan: page 15)
6. **Mix and finalize** — Apply effects, automation, EQ, and panning. Bounce your track. (Mix check: page 16)
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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ALCHEMY ARCHITECT

RUBRIC

Rubric

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Alchemy Architect | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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